

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1487

By Keisling

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Michael "Mike" Earl Tatum.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Michael "Mike" Earl Tatum; and

WHEREAS, Mike Tatum was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Davidson County on February 18, 1944, Mr. Tatum was the son of Bob and Hazel Sexton Tatum; and

WHEREAS, Mike Tatum lived a life defined by selfless service, principled leadership, and a deep, abiding commitment to both his community and his faith; and

WHEREAS, early in his professional career, Mr. Tatum served with acumen and alacrity as both teacher and principal at Westside Elementary School, where he worked tirelessly to lay a strong and lasting foundation for generations of learners; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tatum was proud to serve Macon County High School as vice principal, in which role he demonstrated a deep passion for shaping young lives both inside and outside the classroom; as a basketball and baseball coach, he inspired his student athletes to strive for excellence in academics and athletics alike; and

WHEREAS, following his distinguished career in education, Mike Tatum took a much-deserved retirement from the Macon County Board of Education, leaving behind a legacy of integrity, mentorship, and unwavering dedication to his students and colleagues alike; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected member of his community, Mr. Tatum was a member of the Macon County Retired Teachers Association, the Lions Club, and the Macon County Farm Bureau Board of Directors; and

WHEREAS, Mike Tatum was also devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by his beloved wife of fifty-seven years, Elaine Taylor Tatum; his children, LaDonna (Paul) Little and Michael (YongOk) Tatum; his grandchildren, Jonathan (Brittany) Swaffer, Angela Tatum, and Justin Tatum; his great-grandchildren, Landon Swaffer and Harley Marlow; his step-grandchildren, Leah (David) Brackin, Pauline (Brandon) Coyne, and Jacob Little; three step-great-grandchildren; his brother, Robert "Pat" (Lila) Tatum; his sisters-in-law, Ann Driver and Ruth Gregory; and a host of nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Mr. Tatum was preceded in death by his brother, Phillip Tatum; and

WHEREAS, Mike Tatum was wholly dedicated to his faith, and for forty-nine years, he was a senior adult Sunday School teacher at Lafayette Missionary Baptist Church, guiding others with his wisdom, compassion, and a steadfast devotion to God's Word; he was also a member of Meadorville Missionary Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tatum was a compassionate and faithful soul who greatly impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know him, and he leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Michael "Mike" Earl Tatum, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Tatum.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.